

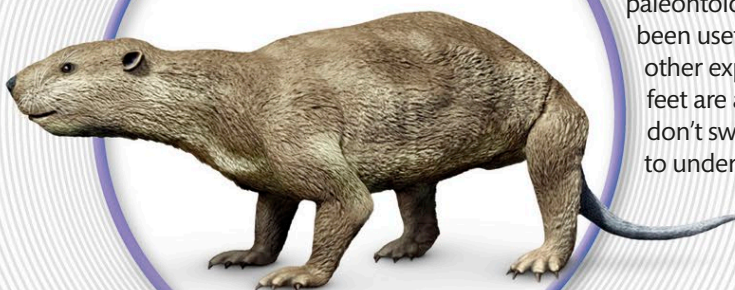
AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 31½ in (80 cm)
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **LIVED** 69–66 MYA
- **HABITAT** Forest undergrowth and floodplains



A SEMIAQUATIC MARSUPIAL?

Scientists don't agree on whether *Didelphodon* lived both on land and in water. Its fossils suggest it had flexible feet, which some paleontologists have argued may have been useful for swimming. However, other experts point out that such flexible feet are also found in mammals that don't swim. More research is needed to understand this creature's lifestyle.



TINY BUT POWERFUL

DIDELPHODON

Scurrying through the undergrowth of Cretaceous forests, the mammal *Didelphodon* did its best to hide from the giant dinosaurs such as *Tyrannosaurus* with whom it shared its habitat. *Didelphodon* had an unusually powerful bite force for a mammal of its size, and it may have been one of the first mammals capable of crunching through hard food such as shell and bone. However, some research suggests that *Didelphodon* rarely used the full force of its bite and that it usually targeted softer prey, from mollusks to dinosaur hatchlings.